Writing Technique (Set B)

Year 4 Pt 2 · **Mark Scheme**

Lesson Worksheet — Answers

Spotting the Technique

1. C — "went" is repeated and tells the reader nothing precise about how the cat moved.
2. An adverb opener — a single adverb ("Slowly,") starts the sentence, followed by a comma.
3. C — it shows boredom through yawning and doodling instead of naming the feeling.
4. A, C, E
5. "Even so" — a contrast connective showing an unexpected result (training hard but still coming last).
6. B (snapped) — a precise verb that also conveys tone/emotion.
7. A — the short sentence "Then: a scream." lands with impact after the longer build-up.
8. Vague/overused adjectives — words that carry little precise meaning and are used too often.
9. B — "Beneath the floorboards," is a prepositional phrase opener.
10. A, C, E — these name the emotion directly rather than showing it through action/detail.
11. B — "Meanwhile" shows two events happening at the same time.
12. Any vivid, precise adjective suggesting size/menace, e.g. "enormous", "hulking", "towering", "massive".
13. Varying sentence length — the very short sentence/fragment "Silence." creates a dramatic pause.
14. "Against all odds"
15. A, C, E — these connect ideas across paragraphs; B and D are unrelated single words.

Applying the Technique

16. e.g. "Creeping along the corridor, the thief checked every door."
17. e.g. "As the sky darkened, the first drops of rain began to fall."
18. e.g. "Mia bounced on her toes, clutching the envelope so tightly it crumpled."
19. A or E (accept either) — both replace every weak word with a precise, vivid alternative.
20. e.g. "However" / "Yet" / "In spite of this"
21. Any answer giving a short dramatic sentence followed by explanatory detail, e.g. "The power went out. For three days, the whole village was left without heating, light or hot water."
22. B, C, E — each varies the opener away from repeated "He".
23. e.g. "Thunder cracked so close that the windows rattled, and the smell of rain seeped under the door."
24. C (Therefore) — shows a result of thorough revision.
25. e.g. "Hurtling down the hill, the boy sped away on his bike."
26. e.g. "The crowd fell silent. The whistle blew, and the race began." (keeping the first sentence short for effect is also acceptable)
27. "bad" → e.g. "bitter", "rancid", "stale", "revolting"
28. e.g. "However" / "By contrast" / "Nevertheless"
29. A, C, D — these vary the opener; B repeats the name and E adds a filler phrase, not true variety.
30. e.g. "The darkness pressed in from every side, swallowing the last of the torchlight. I froze."

Technique in Context

31. It creates sudden, eerie silence after the preceding noise; the abrupt short sentence contrasts sharply with the longer sentences before it, heightening tension and suspense.
32. e.g. "Opening the door, he froze. The mess sprawled across the floor. His bag slipped from his hand as tears welled up."

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33. A, B, E — the sentence opens with an -ing clause, uses "however" to show contrast, and joins two related clauses with a semicolon.
34. It directly names an abstract quality ("deafening silence") instead of letting the reader infer it from concrete detail. Showing version e.g.: "No one moved. No one breathed. Even the clock seemed to have stopped ticking."
35. A — combines the fronted adverbial "With a sudden lurch," with the strong verb "screeched".
36. It repeatedly tells near-identical emotions with no variety in structure. Rewrite e.g.: "My stomach churned and my hands wouldn't stop shaking as I waited for my name to be called."
37. "Despite all this preparation" refers back to the training mentioned earlier and signals a contrast/unexpected outcome, linking the two ideas.
38. B, D — repetitive vague adjectives and a repeated identical opener are both weaknesses to avoid.
39. e.g. "Even so, Omar still felt sick with nerves on the day." — "Even so" signals an unexpected contrast (preparation did not prevent nerves).
40. e.g. "The bell rang. Everyone bolted for the door, some shoving past the others in the rush."
41. A — the long, detailed sentence followed by the single word "Empty." creates the strongest contrast.
42. Any two of: a fronted adverbial (e.g. "With seconds left, ..."), an -ing opener (e.g. "Sprinting towards goal, ..."), an adverb opener (e.g. "Desperately, ..."), a prepositional phrase opener (e.g. "In the final minute, ...").
43. It lets the reader experience/infer the emotion through actions, dialogue and sensory detail, making the writing more vivid and engaging than simply naming the feeling.
44. A, C, E — each replaces a vague verb with a precise, vivid alternative.
45. e.g. "After nine exhausting hours, the summit finally came into view, and with the last of their strength, the climbers hauled themselves over the final ridge. They had made it."

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Homework Worksheet — Answers

Quick Practice

1. B — "Without a sound," is a prepositional phrase opener.
2. e.g. "crept", "tiptoed", "slunk", "edged"
3. C — it shows the sadness through physical detail (brimming eyes, staring at the floor).
4. A, C, E
5. "nice" → e.g. "glorious", "mild", "crisp" ("good" may also be flagged with a precise replacement).
6. It creates sudden drama and impact, mimicking the abruptness of the noise and grabbing the reader's attention immediately.
7. C (As a result) — shows the lateness was a consequence of missing the bus.
8. e.g. "bolted", "sprinted", "tore", "hurtled"
9. A, C, E — each has a comma after the fronted adverbial phrase.
10. "big"
11. C — it shows excitement through repeated checking/packing rather than naming the feeling.
12. B (Consequently) — shows the school closure was a result of the heavy snow.
13. e.g. "Crashing against the rocks, the waves sent spray high into the air."
14. A, C, E — precise, vivid verbs rather than vague ones.
15. "Nevertheless" — shows contrast between the museum closing soon and Grandad's insistence on seeing everything anyway.

Mixed Practice

16. e.g. "He slammed his fist on the table and glared at the wall."
17. e.g. "The team trained hard all season; however, they lost the final."
18. B — varies the opener with an -ing clause and avoids repeating the subject's name three times.
19. e.g. "The rich smell of garlic and herbs filled the kitchen, and the first bite melted in my mouth."
20. A, C, E
21. "got" → e.g. "seized", "claimed", "lifted"; "put" → e.g. "placed", "set" (improving at least one is sufficient).
22. e.g. "At the stroke of midnight, the fireworks lit up the sky."
23. B (Similarly) — shows the comparison between owls and cats.
24. e.g. "Pens tapped against desks and eyes drifted again and again towards the clock."
25. A, C, E
26. e.g. "Thunder exploded overhead, rattling the windows in their frames."
27. Current opener: an adverb opener ("Carefully,"). Rewrite e.g. with an -ing opener: "Lifting the sleeping kitten with great care, Noah held his breath."
28. A — combines the strong verb "devoured" with the cohesive device "consequently".
29. e.g. "My legs ached and my eyelids grew heavier with every step. Exhausted."
30. A, C, E

Standard / Advanced

31. The problem is repetitive use of a vague, overused adjective; the fix is to replace each instance with a different, more precise adjective suited to its context (e.g. "glorious", "pristine", "balmy").
32. e.g. "Within seconds, the torchlight died, and blackness swallowed the room." (fronted adverbial + showing detail)
33. e.g. "As the tide retreated swiftly, the rock pools were exposed." (subordinating connective "As" + strong verb "retreated")
34. e.g. "Without flinching, she stepped onto the narrow ledge." (fronted adverbial opener + show-don't-tell)

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35. Weak verbs: "went"/"said"; no real cohesive link, just "and". Improved: e.g. "Creeping to the door, he murmured something under his breath."
36. Sample answer: "Hacking through the dense jungle, the explorers trudged onward beneath a relentless sun. Sweat soaked their shirts within minutes. Insects swarmed around every exposed inch of skin, and the heat grew more oppressive with each step. Consequently, by midday exhaustion had set in. They could go no further."
37. e.g. Plain: "The boy ran across the road." Improved: "Without looking, the boy bolted across the road." The fronted adverbial adds tension and the strong verb "bolted" conveys urgency and recklessness that "ran" does not.
38. e.g. "Carefully, I opened the box. Inside, lying face up, was an old photograph. Seeing it, I felt a lump rise in my throat." (adverb opener; prepositional/participle opener; -ing opener)
39. e.g. "The weather remained dreadful all week; nevertheless, the sports day went ahead as planned." (cohesive device "nevertheless" + precise adjective "dreadful")
40. A short ending sentence abruptly slows the pace, creating a sense of finality or shock; it mirrors the suddenness of the event, whereas a long sentence would soften the impact.
41. e.g. "Zara's fingers drummed against her script backstage. Her stomach flipped every time the curtain rustled. What if the words simply vanished the moment she stepped into the light?"
42. e.g. "Rising high above the shoreline, the wave crashed down before dragging itself back out to sea." Strongest verb: "crashed" (or "dragging") — it conveys the force of the water far more vividly than a neutral verb like "went".
43. e.g. "The fire spread rapidly, sending thick smoke curling upwards. As the alarm shrieked, everyone fled the building." (varied lengths; connective "As"; stronger verbs "spread rapidly", "shrieked", "fled")
44. Version A simply "tells" the reader the man's emotional state using abstract adjectives; Version B "shows" the same idea through action and visual detail, which is more vivid and lets the reader infer the emotion, making it more engaging.
45. e.g. "Without warning, the waves hurled themselves against the hull, flinging spray across the deck. The sailors braced." (fronted adverbial; strong verbs "hurled"/"flinging"; shows danger without naming fear; short final sentence)

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